

Rosary

Earth rotating like a bead

The bead orbiting a silk cord

Who is the mantra for—

Lakshmi or me?

My feet have worn grooves

around the house

Where I orbit

Up for school

Out the door

7:05

Pick you up

2:30

Snack time

Your bedtime songs have

morphed

I know this because I haven't sung them in years

But I'm sure I never stopped

Like stepping outside at night

then realizing the sun is up
and you barely noticed it rise

Nose against Monet's pond
The underside of a tapestry
The Grand Canyon through a telescope
Made from an empty paper towel roll

Smooth in my hand
Over and over
Dense little foot
Fitting my palm
Eyelashes grazing
your round cheeks
while you sleep

Asking me why
108 times
Hug, kiss
Cut the grapes in half

Strange to be spinning
and never feel it

Strange how still we are
With matched velocity
Mirrored parabolas
Hurling through space

I've looked at the same maple
Every day for ten years
Never seen it grow
Yet it towers now
Dropping its leaves
Extravagantly

You were a baby when we moved in
Now my chin barely rests on your head

Who turns the Earth
Absently in her palm?
Devoted, distracted—
Is she keeping count?
108?
324?

Repetition is a form of change

Nothing lasts forever

If I hold the peach too long

It bruises

So I bite

Juice down my chin

Small, fuzzy planet

Your duckling head

I kiss you mid-orbit

Once

More

Than before

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